EXAMPLE 8.8

A proton and an electron have same de Broglie wavelength. Which of them moves faster and which possesses more kinetic energy?

Solution

We know that $\lambda = \frac{h}{\sqrt{2mK}}$

Since proton and electron have same de Broglie wavelength, we get

$$\frac{h}{\sqrt{2m_pK_p}} = \frac{h}{\sqrt{2m_eK_e}} \text{ (or) } \frac{K_p}{K_e} = \frac{m_e}{m_p}$$

Since $m_e < m_p$, $K_p < K_e$, the electron has more kinetic energy than the proton.

$$\frac{K_p}{K_e} = \frac{\frac{1}{2}m_pv_p^2}{\frac{1}{2}m_ev_e^2} \text{ (or) } \frac{v_p}{v_e} = \sqrt{\frac{K_pm_e}{K_em_p}}$$

$$\frac{v_p}{v_e} = \sqrt{\frac{m_e^2}{m_p^2}} = \frac{m_e}{m_p} \text{ since } \frac{K_p}{K_e} = \frac{m_e}{m_p}$$

Since $m_e < m_p$, $v_p < v_e$, the electron moves faster than the proton.

8.4 X – RAYS

Introduction

Quantum theory of radiation explains photoelectric effect in which the electrons are emitted due to the incidence of photons and the energy is transferred from photons to the electrons. Immediately, a question arises: Is the reverse process also possible?

This means that whether kinetic energy of electron can be transformed into photon energy or not. The phenomenon which answers this question has already been discovered, even before Planck's quantum theory of radiation.

Discovery of x-rays

Wilhelm Roentgen in 1895 discovered that whenever fast moving electrons fall on certain materials, a highly penetrating radiation is emitted. Since their origin was not known at that time, they were called x-rays.

X-rays are electromagnetic waves of short wavelength ranging from 0.1 to 100Å. They travel along straight lines with the velocity of light and are not affected by electric and magnetic fields. X-ray photons are highly energetic because of its high frequency or short wavelength. Therefore, they can pass through materials which are opaque to visible light.

The quality of x-rays is measured in terms of their penetrating power which depends on the velocity with which the electrons strike the target material and the atomic number of target material. The intensity of x-rays is dependent on the number of electrons striking the target.

Production of x-rays

X-rays are produced in x-ray tube which is essentially a discharge tube as shown in Figure 8.20. A tungsten filament *F* is heated to incandescence by a battery. As a result, electrons are emitted from it by thermionic emission.

The electrons are accelerated to high speeds by the voltage applied between the filament *F* and the anode. The target materials like tungsten, molybdenum are embedded in the face of the solid copper anode. The face of the target is inclined at an angle of 45° with respect to the electron beam so that x-rays can leave the tube through its side.

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